

<i>Latin</i>		<i>English</i>
De consecratione, inthronizatione, coronatione Summi Pontificis		On the Consecration, Enthronement, and Coronation of the Supreme Pontiff
Pars II, Caput IX: De orationibus inthronizationis (excerptum)		Part II, Chapter IX: On the Prayers of Enthronement (excerpt)
[...]		[...]
De eorum antiquitate praestat nobis pretiosum testimonium codex manuscriptus bibliothecae Vaticanae Barb. lat. 631 (olim XIV 4), membranaceus, adhuc saeculo XI in scriptura sic dicta Beneventana exaratus ^[^1] , qui exhibet typum Pontificalis saeculi XI. Foliis 132v-133v exhibet textum trium orationum sub eadem rubrica <i>Benedictio pape de episcopo facti</i> nihil adiungendo. Etsi extant duo manuscripta Pontificalis adhuc antiquioris originis et Romano usui destinata, quae ordinem consecrationis summi pontificis XL et XXXVI continent sine nostris orationibus ^[^2] , tamen credimus orationes illas esse pervetustas et secundam substantiam ad tempus ascendere, quo electio episcopi in pontificem adhuc erat exceptio, saeculo sc. X vel adhuc IX. Dicitur enim in prima: <i>Deus qui adesse non dedignaris ubicumque devota mente invocaris adesto quesumus invocationibus nostris et huic famulo tuo N quem ad culmen apostolicum commune iudicium tue plebis elegit apicem pervenisse. per</i> ^[^3] .		Concerning their antiquity, the manuscript codex of the Vatican Library Barb. lat. 631 (formerly XIV 4) provides us with precious testimony. This parchment codex, written in the eleventh century in the so-called Beneventan script ^[^1] , presents a type of Pontifical from the eleventh century. On folios 132v-133v it displays the text of three prayers under the same rubric <i>Benedictio pape de episcopo facti</i> [Blessing of a pope made from a bishop], adding nothing further. Although there exist two manuscripts of the Pontifical of even more ancient origin and destined for Roman use, which contain the order of consecration of the supreme pontiff XL and XXXVI without our prayers ^[^2] , nevertheless we believe those prayers to be very ancient and in their substance to ascend to the time when the election of a bishop to the pontificate was still an exception, namely to the tenth or even ninth century. For it is said in the first prayer: <i>O God, who do not disdain to be present wherever you are invoked with devout mind, be present, we beseech you, to our invocations, and to this your servant N., whom the common judgment of your people has chosen to reach the apostolic summit, may he have attained the highest point. Through...</i> ^[^3] .
Certe non est probabile orationem esse compositam post annum 1059, cum de <i>communi iudicio plebis</i> post decretum Nicolai II bene sermo esse non possit, immo <i>iudicium</i> episcopis cardinalibus reservatum sit ^[^4] . Ex altera parte relationes inter textus orationum et praxim electionum papalium agnoscendas esse credimus. Hae electiones episcoporum, uti iam vidimus, contra canones factae considerabantur. Iustificabantur tamen semper ex facto communis et universalis electionis per		Certainly, it is not probable that the prayer was composed after the year 1059, since after the decree of Nicholas II, there can scarcely be proper discussion of the “ <i>common judgment of the people</i> ,” indeed, <i>judgment</i> was reserved to the cardinal bishops ^[^4] . On the other hand, we believe that the relationships between the texts of the prayers and the practice of papal elections must be recognized. These elections of bishops, as we have already seen, were considered to have been conducted contrary to the canons. Nevertheless, they were always justified by the fact of a common and universal

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populum. Ita de Marino dicitur, electum esse <i>advocatione et eleccione populi Romani</i>^[^5]; de Formoso refertur: <i>Principes falanges et satraphe tui, vulgus et scole tue a maximo usque ad minimum eum elegerunt, acclamaverunt, laudaverunt et adoraverunt...</i>^[^6]. Simili modo de Johanne XIII: <i>Tunc ab omni plebe Romana ... eligitur</i>^[^7]. Eandem intentionem possumus in citata oratione agnoscere; commune iudicium plebis iustificat electionem contra canones factam; inculcatur insuper providentia Dei, qua electus apicem apostolicum adeptus est. Oratio ergo ex conditionibus temporis et pontificum ex episcopis electorum intelligi potest. Simile argumentum praestat tertia oratio; dicitur enim in ea: <i>...respice propitius quesumus super hunc famulum tuum quem de humili cathedra violenter sublatum in thronum // eiusdem apostolorum principis sublimamus ut sicut profectibus tante dignitatis augeatur, ita virtutum meritis cumuletur, quatenus ecclesiastice universitatis onus te adiuuvante digne ferat et a te qui es premium et beatitudo tuorum merita vicem recipiat. qui uiuis</i>^[^8]. Vidimus enim in textu Auxilii, effectum inthronizationis in augmento apostolicae dignitatis constitui. Idem effectus imploratur in oratione tertia: <i>ut profectibus tante dignitatis augeatur!</i> Concordat etiam, quod illi praesentes dixerunt, sc. orationem datam esse in deductione ad apostolicam sedem, nam tertia oratio dici potest proprie oratio inthronizationis. Varias ergo invenimus relationes inter condiciones saeculi IX, quando primi episcopi electi fuerunt in pontifices, et has orationes, ita ut ad minimum improbable non censendum sit, illas ortas esse hoc eodem tempore vel non longe postea, et quoad substantiam iam tempori Formosi adscribi posse.		election by the people. Thus concerning Marinus it is said that he was elected “<i>by the advocacy and election of the Roman people</i>”^[^5]; concerning Formosus it is reported: “<i>Your leading phalanxes and satraps, your common people and your schools, from the greatest to the least, elected him, acclaimed him, praised him, and adored him...</i>”^[^6]. In a similar manner concerning John XIII: “<i>Then by all the Roman people... he is elected</i>”^[^7]. We can recognize the same intention in the cited prayer; the common judgment of the people justifies an election conducted contrary to the canons; moreover, the providence of God is emphasized, by which the elected one has attained the apostolic summit. The prayer, therefore, can be understood from the conditions of the time and of pontiffs elected from among bishops. The third prayer provides a similar argument; for it is said in it: “<i>...look favorably, we beseech You, upon this Your servant whom, violently lifted from a humble chair, we elevate to the throne // of that same prince of the apostles, so that just as he may be increased by the advances of such great dignity, so may he be enriched by the merits of virtues, so that he may worthily bear the burden of ecclesiastical universality with Your assistance, and may receive a reward in return for his merits from You who are the prize and beatitude of Your own. You who live...</i>”^[^8]. For we have seen in the text of <i>Auxilius</i> that the effect of enthronement consists in an increase of apostolic dignity. The same effect is implored in the third prayer: “<i>so that he may be increased by the advances of such great dignity!</i>” It also agrees with what those present said, namely, that the prayer was given in the conducting to the apostolic see, for the third prayer can properly be called the prayer of enthronement. We find, therefore, various relationships between the conditions of the ninth century, when the first bishops were elected as pontiffs, and these prayers, so that it should not be deemed improbable, at the very least, that they arose in this same time or not long afterward, and that as to their substance they can already be ascribed to the time of Formosus.
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[^1]: {org. 294} E. A. LOEW, <i>The Beneventan Script. A History of the South Italian Minuscule</i> , Oxford 1914, 292 n. 2, 365.		[^1]: {org. 294} E. A. Loew, <i>The Beneventan Script. A History of the South Italian Minuscule</i> , Oxford 1914, 292 n. 2, 365.
[^2]: {org. 295} Codex Cassinensis 451 et codex D. 5 bibliothecae Vallicellianae, de quibus cf. ANDRIEU, <i>Ordines</i> I 194, 200, 527. — Pontificale in codice Sessoriano 52 bibliothecae nationalis Vittorio Emmanuele Romae conservatum est quidem pro usu capellae pontificiae, sed desunt etiam alii ordines consecrationis summi pontificis. Est saec. XI et hodie numero 2096 signatus. De eo cf. ANDRIEU l. c. I 287-294, 484, 472.		[^2]: {org. 295} Cassinese Codex 451 and Codex D. 5 of the Vallicellian Library, concerning which cf. ANDRIEU, <i>Ordines</i> I 194, 200, 527. — The Pontifical preserved in Sessorian Codex 52 of the Vittorio Emanuele National Library in Rome is indeed for the use of the pontifical chapel, but other orders for the consecration of the Supreme Pontiff are also missing. It is from the 11th century and today bears the number 2096. Concerning it cf. ANDRIEU l. c. I 287-294, 484, 472.
[^3]: {org. 296} Textus secundum Barb. lat. 631 fol. 132 v-133. (Signum // indicat initium novi folii).		[^3]: {org. 296} Text according to Barb. lat. 631 fol. 132 v-133. (The symbol // indicates the beginning of a new folio).
[^4]: {org. 297} Decretum anni 1059 § 2, EBERS 44.		[^4]: {org. 297} Decree of the year 1059 § 2, EBERS 44.
[^5]: {org. 298} <i>Invectiva in Romam</i> , ed. Dümmler, <i>Gesta Berengarii</i> 145.		[^5]: {org. 298} <i>Invectiva in Romam</i> , ed. Dümmler, <i>Gesta Berengarii</i> 145.
[^6]: {org. 299} Ibidem 141.		[^6]: {org. 299} Ibidem 141.
[^7]: {org. 300} <i>Continuatio Reginonis</i> ad ann. 965, <i>Rer. Germ. SS.</i> 176.		[^7]: {org. 300} <i>Continuatio Reginonis</i> for the year 965, <i>Rer. Germ. SS.</i> 176.
[^8]: {org. 301} Barb. lat. 631, fol. 133-133 v.		[^8]: {org. 301} Barb. lat. 631, fol. 133-133 v.